



MARKET COMPETITION ANALYSIS · STACKED AGAINST MANIFESTO v4.0

THE FIELD, AND THE DOCUMENT

Motto, Content Shift and webpopular measured against Message Masters as version 4.0 actually defines it. Including the places where our own document says we are exposed.

STEP THREE OF OUR OWN METHOD

The nine step method in Section 9 puts this at number three: read the competitors honestly, including where they are genuinely better. It sits ahead of discovering the purpose, which means we have been selling a method whose third step we had never run on ourselves. This closes it.

HELD TO THE VERIFICATION STANDARD

Section 2 obligates us to trace every claim. This analysis is held to the same rule. Every statement about a competitor comes from their own published material, their own search footprint, or a public record, and every statement about us comes from version 4.0 or from our own site as it currently reads. Where a figure is estimated, it says estimated.

HELD TO THE DISTINCTNESS STANDARD

A competitive study that concludes we are better at everything is a compliment with footnotes, which is exactly what Section 2 forbids. Three of the pages here are about where they beat us and where our own document says we are weak.

WHAT CHANGED NOW THAT V4.0 IS THE SOURCE

- **One correction.** The earlier draft said we have no documented client outcomes. Version 4.0 records four, from the September 2026 surveys, against a target of ten. Four is thin. It is not zero, and the distinction matters because four is a base to build on.
 - **The top of the range is already decided.** Section 7.2 states that above \$10M we compete with firms that have proof at that scale and we do not yet. That answers the Motto question before it gets asked, and it removes a strategic choice I had listed as open.
 - **Two real differentiators appeared that no competitor in this set has.** Verification as a published standard, and the adoption package. Neither existed in the material I first scored.
 - **Our known weaknesses are now numbers rather than impressions.** Adoption under fifty percent. Alignment two of four. Six non branded clicks in a year. Those are more useful than anything I could have inferred from outside.
-

THERE ARE TWO MESSAGE MASTERS

One is written down in a fifteen section document that verifies its own claims and states its own failures. The other is a homepage whose first line reads full-service marketing, a phrase version 4.0 lists as forfeiting the entire position. Both are real. Only one of them competes.

MESSAGE MASTERS, AS WRITTEN

v4.0 fully deployed

204

MOTTO

deployed

197

CONTENT SHIFT

deployed

129

MESSAGE MASTERS, AS VISIBLE

what a stranger finds

116

WEBPOPULAR

deployed

105

INSIGHT PRO TOTAL, OUT OF 250. BOTH MESSAGE MASTERS FIGURES ARE ESTIMATES.

AS WRITTEN • 204

Strongest foundation in the set, ahead of a global firm with twenty years and a published book. Purpose, mission, vision, values, story, audience, differentiators, promises, method and position are all present, all distinct, and now all sourced. Nothing in this score is aspiration. It is the document scored as if it were deployed.

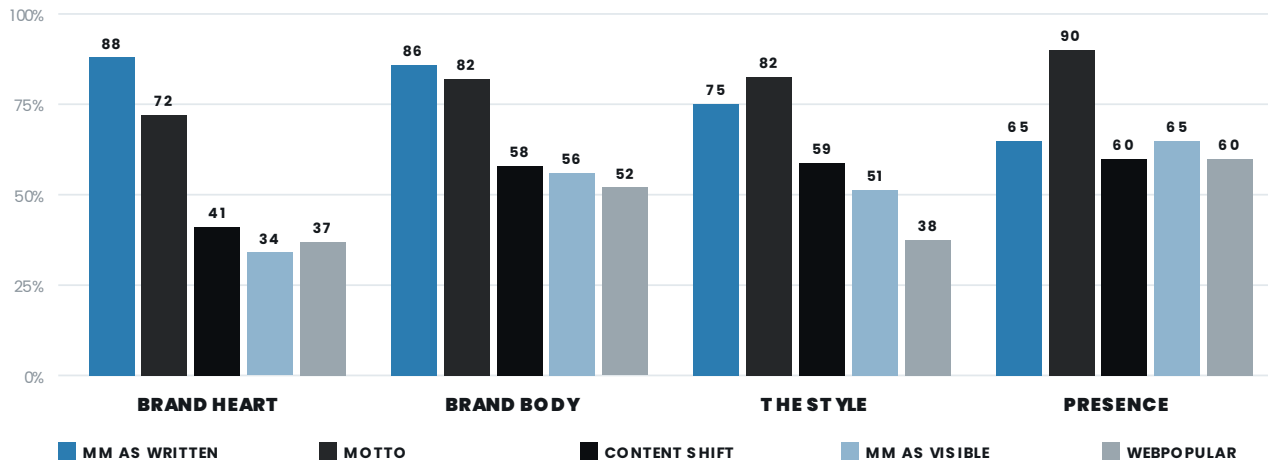
AS VISIBLE • 116

Fourth of five. Below Content Shift, above webpopular. The four step method is not on the site. The three differentiators are not on the site. The current tagline is not on the site. The eight service tiles contradict the six offerings. A stranger cannot find the company this document describes.

Eighty eight points of the gap between those two numbers sit in the Heart, and none of that gap requires new thinking, new capability, or new money. It requires publishing what is already written. Section 6.7 named this pattern before I did: this firm applies its own instrument to everyone except itself.

FIVE COMPANIES, FOUR SECTIONS

Message Masters appears twice on purpose. The distance between the two blue bars is the entire strategic problem, and it is widest in the section that carries the most points.



WHERE WRITING ALONE CLOSSES IT

Brand Heart and Brand Body. From 34 to 88 and from 28 to 43 with no new capability required. This is a publishing problem, not a capability problem.

WHERE WRITING CANNOT CLOSE IT

The Style caps at 60 out of 80 even fully deployed, because Section 11 names the standing gap: we sell fifty photographs and eleven videos and own neither of ourselves. Presence does not move at all from a document. It moves from routing, reviews and time.

WHO ELSE MEETS THEM

	MM	CONTENT SHIFT	MOTTO	WEB POPULAR	NOTE
Verification as a published standard	YES	No	No	No	Section 2. Nobody else in this set publishes an evidence standard, let alone their own negative findings.
Adoption handled after delivery	YES	No	Partial	No	Handbook, 30 and 90 day check ins, six coaching sessions. Motto offers internal launch support inside its largest program.
Purpose discovery before any expression	YES	No	YES	No	Motto runs interviews and workshops. They do not then produce the video.
Discovery and production under one roof	YES	No	No	Partial	Our first differentiator, and it holds up against all three.
A written governing document as the product	YES	No	YES	No	Motto sells strategy and guidelines. Ours is a fifteen section document with a Plain Page and a Brand File.
Published method a buyer can read	No	Partial	YES	No	Section 13 objective. They publish, we do not.
Paid diagnostics as the entry product	YES	No	No	No	\$299 INSIGHT. Everyone else offers a free call or a free audit.
Documented client outcomes	4	Awards	YES	YES	Ours are four structured surveys against a target of ten.
Stated refusals and disqualifiers	YES	No	No	No	Section 7.6 and the four warning signs. Nobody else publishes who they turn away.
Automated route to a first meeting	No	No	YES	YES	Section 13 names this. Currently routed to nobody.
Local reputation in Denton County	YES	No	No	YES	76 five star reviews at 5.0. Best of Denton County, two years running.

THE TWO ROWS THAT DECIDE THE QUARTER

Published method and automated route to a first meeting. They are the only two rows where we are beaten by someone we actually compete with, and they are both already written down as objectives in Section 13.

WHO TAKES WHAT

CONTENT SHIFT

LARGER TEAMS, AND THE EXPRESSION SALE

Section 9 names larger teams and cheaper agencies as two of the six things we lose to. Content Shift is the credible version of the first. An Emmy, thirty five awards, the Mavericks and Whataburger on the wall, thirteen years, and crews that flex from two people to a full commercial unit. When a buyer has already decided he is purchasing a video, he is choosing between buying a video and buying the reason it is worth shooting, and their reel wins the first of those comparisons.

They have no discovery product and no About page, no values, no mission, and no named people. They cannot answer what the film should say. They also run a white label channel for agencies, which under the Quarterback Model makes them a specialist we could hire rather than a firm we lose to.

MOTTO

THE CATEGORY, NOT THE CLIENT

Section 7.2 already settles this. Above ten million dollars we compete with firms that have proof at that scale and we do not yet. Motto works with Google, Disney and Microsoft out of New York, London and Dallas. They are not taking our clients and we are not taking theirs.

What they take is the language. Their method is published, their programs are trademarked, and their vocabulary is the material a North Texas CEO will find when he goes looking for what we do. Section 5.3 states the intent to make the category exist. Motto is currently doing that work and putting their name on it.

WEB POPULAR

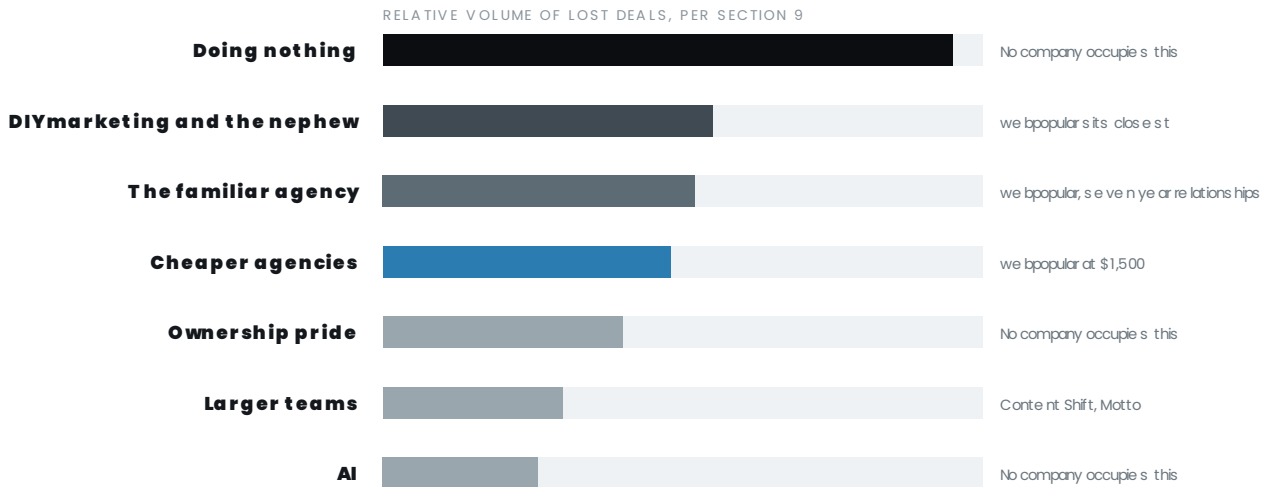
THE FIRST CALL, AND THE SIX CLICKS

This is the one that costs us real money, and version 4.0 hands us the number that proves it. Ninety five percent of our web traffic is branded. Six non branded clicks in a year. Meanwhile he ranks for the searches an owner actually types in our own county, with a free audit, an instant quote and a cost estimator waiting at the end of them.

He is in Argyle, he is an Argyle Insider's Preferred Partner, he works the same rooms, and his longest client relationship is past seven years. That is the familiar agency from Section 9, and familiarity beats superiority even when the familiar option has a record of producing nothing. His brand scored 105. His offer scored 8 out of 10, the highest single item in the study.

ONLY TWO OF THE SIX ARE COMPANIES

Version 4.0 already lists what we lose to. Placing the three firms against that list is more useful than ranking them against each other, because it shows how little of our lost revenue any of them actually holds.



WHAT THIS MEANS FOR THE STUDY

Three of the seven bars have no company standing on them at all. Doing nothing, ownership pride and AI are not competitors we can outsell, outprice or outproduce. They are competitors we can only outteach, which is why Section 5.3 makes teaching the growth strategy rather than a brand building luxury. A competitor study that ended at Motto, Content Shift and webpopular would have addressed roughly a third of the problem.

WHERE THE DOCUMENT SAYS WE ARE WEAK

Every figure here is published inside version 4.0. No competitor in this study publishes anything comparable about itself, which is simultaneously to our credit and the reason this page is uncomfortable.

Clients using the document at 90 days

Headline number in v4.0



Under 50%

Client teams stating one purpose

Alignment claim stays out of front material



2 of 4

Documented outcomes in a client's words

Target set in Section 13



4 of 10

Non branded clicks in a year

Ninety five percent of traffic is branded



6

Owned photography and video

We sell 50 photos and 11 videos



None

Named advisors in the channel

The channel we have never built



0 of 20

THE COMPETITIVE READING

Adoption is the one that compounds. A client who does not deploy the work produces no outcome, no alignment, no referral and no case study, which starves the exact proof layer we need to compete above ten million dollars. The adoption package is the correct response and its result is not yet known.

THE ONE NOBODY ELSE SHARES

Six non branded clicks in a year. webpopular publishes a page of first page rankings. Motto ranks for category terms. Content Shift at least owns its own name. We are effectively unfindable by anyone who does not already know we exist, in a business whose stated growth constraint is first meetings.

WHAT V4.0 GIVES US THAT NONE OF THEM HAVE

Each of these passes the same test the differentiators pass: a competitor in this set could not claim it without lying.

VERIFICATION

Section 2

Nobody else in the category shows the evidence before the claim. It is also the answer to the second enemy, which is the client who has the words and will not say them. That failure mode is invisible to every competitor here because none of them has named it.

THE ORDER, ENFORCED

Section 3

No expression before purpose is written down, at any price, for any client. Content Shift produces without it by definition. webpopular has no version of it. Motto has the order and stops before production.

THE ROOM

Section 9

Twenty years of vocational ministry before a day of agency work. Least copyable asset in the company, and it was built somewhere else over two decades.

ADOPTION

Section 8

An implementation handbook, two check ins and six coaching sessions through a partner. The industry sells delivery. We are now selling the ninety days after delivery, which is where the result actually lives.

ONE ROOF

Differentiator 01

We find it, we build it. The industry splits this in two and hands the client two documents from two firms who never spoke. Nobody in this set does both ends.

STATED REFUSALS

Section 7.6

We publish who we turn away and we have declined work over it. None of the three publishes a disqualifier. A firm that will take anyone is telling a \$7M owner something he can hear.

FIVE MOVES, ALL OF THEM ALREADY IN V4.0

Not one of these is a new idea. Every one is an objective the document already sets. The contribution of this analysis is the order and the reason.

1

PUBLISH THE COMPANY THAT IS ALREADY WRITTEN

Section 6.7 · This month

The homepage opens with the one phrase Section 10 forbids. The method, the three differentiators, the tagline and the six offerings all exist in finished form and none of them is on the site. Eighty eight points of the gap between our two scores closes with copy that is already drafted. Nothing else on this list should start first.

2

GIVE THE INSIGHT A ROUTE

Section 13 · This quarter

The only paid diagnostic in the study, routed to nobody, in a business whose stated binding constraint is first meetings. webpopular has five automated ways to raise a hand and a weaker product at the end of them.

3

BUILD THE ADVISOR CHANNEL

Section 7.4 · This quarter

Six non branded clicks a year means search is not going to produce the meetings. Fifteen to twenty named CPAs, attorneys, bankers, brokers and implementers, each handed the INSIGHT as the artifact a professional can pass along without risking his own credibility.

4

MOVE ADOPTION FROM UNDER HALF

Section 13 · Track from day one

It is now the headline number and it feeds everything we lack. Outcomes, alignment, referrals and the proof we need to ever compete above ten million dollars all sit downstream of a client actually using the document.

5

SHOOT OURSELVES

Section 11 · This quarter

The single largest contradiction between what we say and what we show, named in our own document. We sell fifty photographs and eleven videos and own neither. Content Shift's entire advantage is a reel. Ours is a document nobody can see and work nobody can watch.

THE FIELD IS NOT THE PROBLEM

Motto is a different league and their own client list says so. Content Shift is a production company with an empty centre and a real reel, and on a large shoot they are a supplier rather than a rival. webpopular is a capable operator with no brand and an excellent front door. None of the three is doing what version 4.0 describes, and none of them is positioned to start.

Scored as written, this company has the strongest foundation of the five entries in this study. Scored as visible, it is fourth. That gap is not a strategy problem, a market problem or a competitor problem. It is the pattern Section 6.7 already named, measured against three companies who have less to say and say it everywhere.

Section 15 says version 4.0 is a correction and not a cure, and that the pattern will return. The test of whether it was real is not whether the document is good. It is whether the homepage still says full-service marketing ninety days from now.



MESSAGE MASTERS

Discover your value. Share it with the world.